



Voice-controlled microwave

Amazon has created the AmazonBasic Microwave that connects to the Echo to allow you to bark commands at the microwave. <https://dgit.in/dec18-41-1>



Unlimited God Mode

A Fallout 76 bug granted Redditor Brogadyn unlimited God Mode at around Level 40 and persists till date at Level 100. <https://dgit.in/dec18-41-01>

It's a whole lot of other cameras other than a head mounted camera, but in terms of the essence of acting, there is no difference.

You are the face behind iconic characters like Gollum from LOTR, Snoke in Star Wars, Caesar in Planet of the Apes...You were the voice and mo-cap for King Bohan in Sony's Heavenly Sword and Monkey in Enslaved: Odyssey to the West. How do you don such diverse roles and manage to bring a unique personality to each one of them?

Serkis: It's about being bold enough to really believe that you are that character. It's about the power of the imagination. It's about really making yourself lose any inhibition and not be vain about seeing your face on the screen and actually want to thoroughly become something else. And that's the heart of it. What I love about acting is the art of transforming.

The Jungle book and Mowgli are very Indian in their roots. Can you talk about how that affected your decisions while making the movie?

Serkis: From day one, we attempted to not make a whitewashed version of the story, like many other adaptations have done. It is set in India, written by somebody who grew up in India, so the first person that came aboard, the very first collaborator that I had was Nitin Sawhney, who is a British-Indian composer. The design and placement of it (the film) is very Indian in nature. A lot of the cast is Indian. We also had Hindi speaking Indians in the village sequences, it was all very important.

Since the text and origin of Mowgli is so dated, what is the message that the film is trying to get across in the modern context?

Serkis: There are many messages. We wanted it to be about the search for belonging. There are many people in this world who feel they don't particu-



Bale wearing the performance capture gear

larly belong anywhere, that they have been displaced. The world is full of refugees in a way. That's what the story is about. It's about how do you find your home and knowing yourself and finding yourself. It's also about perilous situations. Places like the jungle are threatened by human beings and we've reached a tipping point in the world now where if we are not careful, we will lose these places of great beauty. I also wanted to somehow tap into the idea of colonisation, change and encroachment, and that's what the story is about.

As a director, how do you feel about your film being acquired by Netflix and it releasing on a streaming platform instead of getting a traditional theatrical release?

Serkis: I am delighted that Netflix has acquired this because it's meant that we have a big global reach immediately. We are having a limited theatrical release so you can see it on the big screen as well. I am most thrilled that we are having our world premiere in Mumbai and that wouldn't have happened if we had gone down the traditional route.

Talking about donning the role of Bagheera, the Black Panther, Christian Bale told us that he is in fact very familiar with the writings of legendary author Rudyard Kipling.

Bale: I had read the Jungle Book as a kid in school. I was never a very good student, didn't really pay much atten-

tion. So, when Andy came to me, I did know primarily that my preference was the Disney animated film, the musical and Bare Necessities and floating down the river on Baloo's tummy. I loved that film. I've known Andy since I was about 19 years old. He's become the pre-eminent go-to actor when it comes to performance capture. I feel like it's a story that lends itself to multiple interpreta-

tions. You can equally love Disney's and this interpretation. It's fascinating to me that how the same source material can end up in such vastly different style of film. While Disney's version is warm and fuzzy, this one is a fantasy adventure.

Given that his latest stint as Bagheera the panther involves a lot of play with motion capture, we asked Bale if wearing the mocap suit actually made his life more difficult as an actor. What you might not notice when you finally watch the film is the fact that almost all of Bagheera's movements, the way he carries Mowgli on his back, the way he scratches and jumps on all fours, are actually performed by Bale in real life wearing a face and motion capture suit. The animation data gathered from the suit was then mapped to a 3D model of Bagheera, making the character perform the same actions as the actor.

Bale: Initially you feel a little lost doing this. You're not sure what's important and what's not important. Andy was able to communicate that to me very quickly. It's not just the voice, that's what a lot of people misunderstand, because you are actually interacting, you are acting, you are moving. It's not more demanding, just demanding in a different way. Whenever you act there are lots of distractions and you have to try to ignore them. What you see, the positions we all are sitting in, were the positions that I chose and they then adapted them to turn me into a panther. It's a new age of what becomes possible in film. 